SHANNON | EINN

PILOT BRIEFING



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Welcome to Shannon!

We are delighted to host this year's WorldFlight teams at Shannon, an airport with deep ties to the history of transatlantic flight! The first non-stop flight across the Atlantic crash-landed in nearby Clifden in 1919. Some years later, the invention of the flying boat turned the port at Foynes (located just 15km West of Shannon Airport) into one of the busiest airports in Europe. As aviation continued to advance, an actual airport with a paved runway became a necessity. Shannon Airport was therefore opened in 1942 with the primary purpose of serving as a fuel-stop for flights between Europe and North-America; a purpose it continued to serve all the way up to 2020, when the daily British Airways A318 flight from London to New York via Shannon was canceled.

Fun Fact!

Did you know that Shannon Airport was selected by NASA as one of the Space Shuttle's emergency landing sites? The US government even offered to pay compensation if the Shuttle missed the airport and crashed into a populated area. Although Shannon was never actually used for this purpose, the runway was sterilised and emergency crews were prepared for a full turnout every time the Space Shuttle launched from Florida.

Despite its long runway and historical significance, Shannon is now a relatively quiet airport used by many airlines for base training and maintenance. The airport is not designed to accommodate the volume of traffic that WorldFlight will bring to it, so special procedures will be in place to make sure the event runs smoothly. This briefing outlines some of these procedures and serves as a guide for what you can expect when flying into / out of Shannon during WorldFlight 2026.

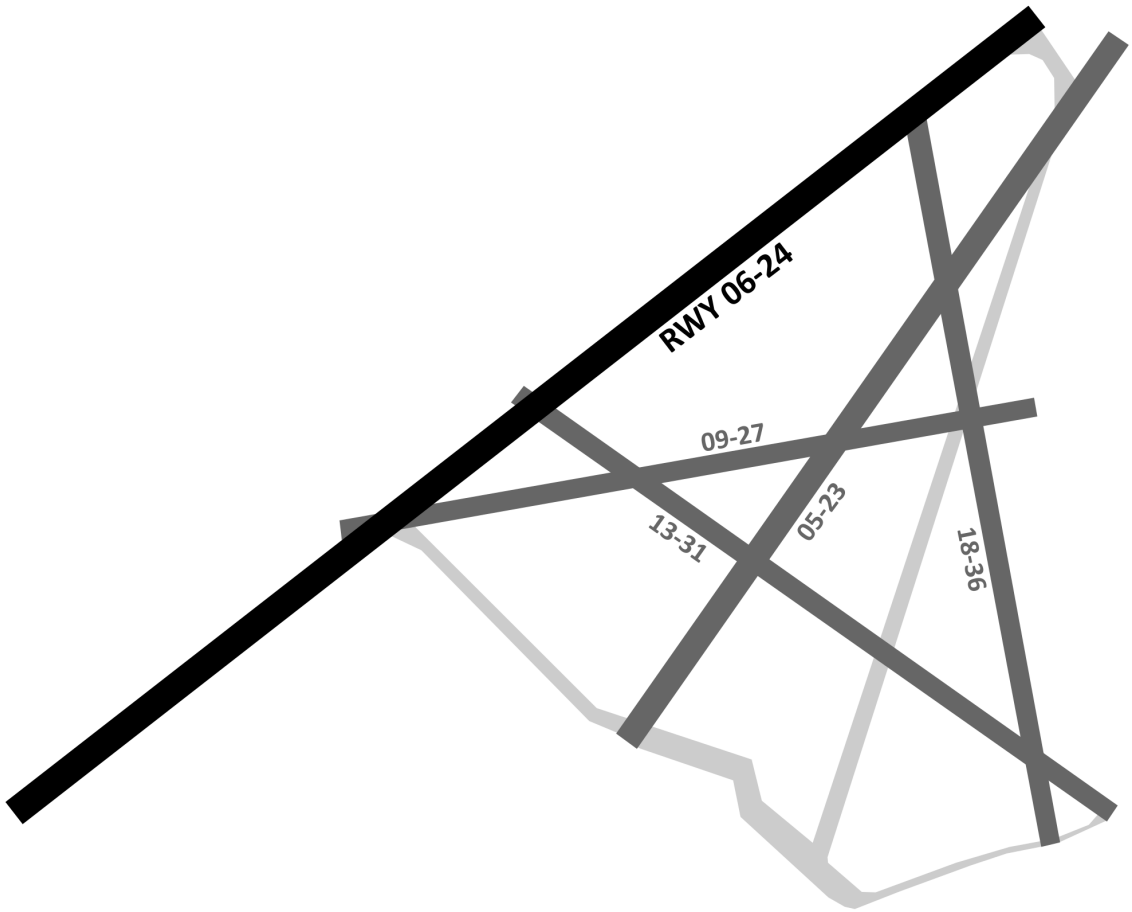
On behalf of VATéir and all of our controllers and staff,

Fáilte go mBaile na Sionnainne | *Welcome to Shannon*

Charts

Charts for Shannon Airport (as well as all Irish airports) can be found in the Irish AIP.
Don't forget to check our WordFlight Edition Aerodrome Chart and Parking & Docking Chart

Airport Layout



Although Shannon Airport had **five (!)** intersecting runways at one point, it now operates with just one **(RWY 06-24)**, which is due to be re-designated next month! Some sections of the old runways are now used as taxiways or as long-term aircraft parking, but most of them are disused. However, we will be making full use of all the available pavement during WorldFlight 2026, so make sure to check our custom Aerodrome Chart before you fly!

Stands

Since the 20 usable stands on the main apron won't be enough to accommodate the unusually large volume of aircraft that WorldFlight will bring to Shannon, we have picked out an additional 25 locations around the airfield that are suitable for parking. These WorldFlight stands can be found on our custom Parking & Docking Chart. **Official** Teams should expect to be assigned one of these ad-hoc stands. WF **Affiliates** will also be assigned these stands where possible, but may need to park at the main apron in some cases. **Non-event** aircraft will be parked at the main apron, or even on grass areas if space runs out. Main apron stands can be found in the Irish AIP.

Arrival Procedures

You will most likely be assigned a STAR prior to your descent into Shannon. All STARs are RNAV and terminate at the Initial Approach Fix for the corresponding ILS approach. You may be vectored off the STAR for delay if it's very busy; you can expect to be re-cleared on the STAR or vectored all the way to the localiser.

Holding

If the traffic situation demands it, holding may become necessary. When instructed to hold, reduce to your **minimum clean speed** and ensure the hold information in your FMC matches the information on your STAR chart (or on the table below).

RWY	Holding Fix	Inbound Course	Turn Direction	Leg Length
06	ELPOM	056°	Left	1 min
24	DERAG	237°	Right	1 min
24	EKNIS	074°	Left	1 min

Once established in the hold, maintain a rate of descent of **1000 ft/min**, unless explicitly told otherwise.

Landing

If **RWY 24** is in use, plan to vacate via **TWY A** or earlier. This gives an approximate landing distance (LDA) of just over **2000 m**. Missing TWY A will require backtracking the runway to vacate, so please advise EINN_APP as soon as possible if you expect you will not be able to make the exit. If you do need to back-track after landing, you can do so anywhere on the runway; the majority of aircraft do not need to taxi all the way to the turn-pad at the end of the runway to make the 180° turn, this will result in go-arounds and delays for aircraft behind you.

If the Space Shuttle could vacate via TWY A, so can you!

Departure Procedures

Your assigned SID will depend on your destination and runway-in-use, as per the table below.

ADES	RWY 24	RWY 06
EGSS	PELIG3B	DIGAN3A
EGKB	ABAGU3B	ABAGU3A

Note: Aircraft cleared on a DIGAN3A departure are expected to fly:
EINN DIGAN3A DIGAN **DCT PELIG** DCT BOFUM …

Engine Start

Aircraft parked at the remote WorldFlight stands may be required to start their engines on stand and taxi out, or push-back onto an adjacent taxiway, depending on the traffic situation. If unsure what to do, ask EINN_GND for clarification.

Intersection Departures

Take-offs will be permitted from a number of intersections for aircraft capable of doing so. The table below provides approximate distances (TORA) for use in take-off performance calculations. Advise EINN_GND as soon as possible if you're able to depart from an intersection.

TWY	RWY 24	RWY 06
C	2703 m	-
G	2400 m	-
H2	1560 m	1630 m
9	-	1980 m
A	-	2067 m

After Departure

The initial climb on all SIDs is **5000 ft**. Do not exceed this unless instructed.

Switch to Shannon Approach (121.405) when passing 1000 ft. Tower will not give you a handover on departure.

Go raibh míle maith agat agus bíodh eitilt deas | *Thank you and have a nice flight!*

Irish vacc of vatsim | roinn vatsim na hÉireann

